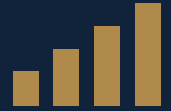


Ralf Lauwers

Senior IT Program & Portfolio Manager | 20+ Years | Digital & Infrastructure Transformation | Logistics, Government, Pharma, Telecom & Banking



CONTACT INFORMATION

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Location: Vosselaar, Belgium

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/ralflauwers/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a Senior IT Program, Portfolio & PMO Manager with 20+ years of experience delivering complex IT initiatives across Logistics, Government, Pharma, Telecom, and Banking. I specialize in large-scale infrastructure, cloud, and digital transformation programs, aligning IT delivery with business strategy in regulated, mission-critical environments.

Throughout my career, I have led multi-million-euro programs, coordinated cross-functional and vendor teams, and established robust governance and portfolio frameworks. My expertise spans infrastructure modernization, ERP implementations, cloud adoption, and PMO setup, always with a focus on measurable business outcomes, risk reduction, and operational excellence.

I am particularly effective in environments that require clarity, structure, and stakeholder trust. Whether working with executive sponsors, CIOs, architects, or external partners, I bring a structured, transparent leadership style that ensures alignment across technical and non-technical teams. I am known for building high-performing, multi-cultural teams and delivering results in complex, international programs.

Hands-on, pragmatic, and people-centric, I balance governance with agility, discipline with flexibility, and strategy with execution. Curiosity, organization, and a sense of humor drive how I lead and collaborate.

Currently open to IT Program Manager, IT Portfolio Manager, or PMO Manager opportunities where large-scale transformation, governance, and strategic alignment matter.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Security Program Manager

Cronos Security · Freelance

Jul 2026 – Present · Kontich, Belgium (Hybrid)

- Provide presales and delivery support for Cronos Security customers.
- Serve as Program Manager Security for IGA/IAM/PAM projects delivered on Omada Identity.

Project Implementation Manager & Team Lead ITS Moving

Gosselin Group · Freelance

Sep 2025 – Mar 2026 · Antwerp, Belgium (Hybrid)

Reporting to: CIO

- Led IT project and program delivery for the Moving division, aligning infrastructure and ERP initiatives with business priorities in an international logistics environment.
- Established and operationalized an IT PMO based on Prince2 and Agile methodologies, defining governance, delivery standards, reporting structures, and portfolio visibility to improve decision-making and execution control.
- Managed ERP vendor relationships, overseeing planning, execution, and performance to ensure alignment with contractual and business expectations.
- Acted as a core member of the strategic management team, reporting directly to the CIO and supporting IT investment prioritization, roadmap planning, risk management, and change management.
- Built and led a multidisciplinary IT team, improving collaboration, accountability, and delivery predictability across projects and initiatives.

Program Manager / Senior Project Manager IT Infrastructure

CM – Christelijke Mutualiteit · Freelance

Nov 2023 – May 2025 · Brussels, Belgium (Hybrid)

Reporting to: Service Delivery Manager & BU Managers

Budget: 4.500K€

- Led a multi-stream IT infrastructure program — network, network security, security (IGA/IAM/PAM), and telephony projects — applying Prince2 and Agile methodologies to deliver on time and within budget, supporting mission-critical services across 300+ offices.
- Directed a major data center network upgrade and office network switch/Wi-Fi refresh initiatives, coordinating vendors and internal teams to minimize disruption.
- Defined and maintained the Infrastructure Program Roadmap, enabling structured investment planning, prioritization, and visibility of future initiatives.
- Managed risks, dependencies, governance, and change, improving execution predictability and alignment with organizational priorities.
- Facilitated stakeholder engagement, ensuring cross-functional collaboration and alignment with IT strategy.

Program / Project Manager Digitization for the Cloud Center of Excellence

Umicore · Freelance

Feb 2023 – Nov 2023 · Antwerp, Belgium (Hybrid)

Reporting to: CCoE Manager

- Led enterprise cloud programs across IT and Business Units, supporting digital transformation initiatives.
- Defined cloud governance, KPIs, and delivery standards to ensure consistent and controlled cloud adoption.
- Managed cross-functional and international teams, coordinating IT, security, architecture, and business stakeholders.
- Oversaw SaaS and IaaS implementations, improving platform agility and aligning with security, cost, and operational requirements.
- Enabled business-led innovation through cloud platforms, accelerating time-to-delivery and strengthening IT-business alignment.

Program/Project Manager Finance Transformation

PwC Belgium · Freelance

Sep 2022 – Feb 2023 · Brussels, Belgium (Hybrid)

Reporting to: CIO & Portfolio Manager & PMO

- Led the Finance Transformation IT stream (22 FTE) through a 50-FTE KYC/AML/Billing reorganisation into a new operating model supported by new software and automation.
- Drove digital transformation initiatives, streamlining processes, improving efficiency, and enhancing reporting transparency.
- Implemented finance systems and automation tools, enabling cost control and data-driven decision-making.
- Established program governance, ensuring alignment between finance leadership, IT, and business objectives.
- Facilitated stakeholder engagement and change adoption, enabling smooth transitions to new operating models.

Program/Project Manager IT Transformation, Interim Product Owner & Scrum Master, Interim Team Lead Infrastructure & Operations (8 FTE), Interim Team Lead Enterprise Architects (4 FTE), Client Transition Manager for a Managed Service Provider (MSP)

Coreso SA · Freelance

Jul 2021 – Jul 2022 · Brussels, Belgium

Reporting to: CIO & PMO

Budget: 5.600K€

- Led IT Transformation Program, coordinating 12 engineers to deliver enterprise modernization initiatives.
- Directed MSP client transition, ensuring seamless handover while maintaining service continuity.
- Established program governance, KPIs, and reporting frameworks for transparency and alignment with strategy.
- Implemented cloud and infrastructure solutions, improving efficiency and scalability.
- Facilitated stakeholder alignment, bridging IT and business needs to ensure adoption and measurable results.

EMEA IT Infrastructure Program Manager

Johnson & Johnson · Freelance

Jul 2019 – Dec 2019 · Beerse, Belgium

Reporting to: PMO

Budget: 9.200K€

- Directed replacement of CISCO-based network and security infrastructure across 37 sites in 13 EMEA countries, minimizing disruption and meeting timelines.
- Developed and executed transition plans, including risk mitigation and vendor coordination.

- Implemented modernized network and security solutions, enhancing connectivity, reliability, and security posture.
- Managed project governance and budget tracking, providing leadership with clear reporting and metrics.
- Facilitated international collaboration, coordinating IT teams, local site managers, and vendors to ensure consistent standards.

IT Manager and Business Consultant

Master Meubel · Freelance

Apr 2019 – Jul 2019 · Turnhout, Belgium

- Designed, planned, and executed the consolidation and expansion of local and remote IT infrastructure.

IT Manager & Project/Program Manager & Business Consultant

Self Employed · Freelance

Apr 2008 – Mar 2019 · Belgium

- Supported the start-up and management of different SME's in Real-Estate, Construction, Food & Beverages, and Finance & Insurance.

Sabbatical

Apr 2006 – Mar 2008

- Took some time off to travel.

Project Manager

HP · Aug 1999 – May 2006 · Belgium

- Led IT infrastructure project consolidation with full P&L responsibility — projects ranging in size from 2 to 15 team members, with budgets from €50K to €5M.
- Key player managing the HP services delivery team across Belgium, Norway, the Netherlands and the USA.
- Bid Manager for the Strategic Bid Center during contract bid and negotiation.

World Wide Service Manager

HP · Aug 2001 – Aug 2002

- Framed and defined Storage Area Management solutions; managed solution development and roll-out; developed the services and solutions collateral; and assisted the HPC field organization in selling the services and solutions.

IT Consultant

HP · Aug 1999 – Aug 2001 · Brussels Metropolitan Area

- Responsible for the integration of IT projects for large corporate accounts, focused on Microsoft Server solutions and HP Storage solutions.

IT Manager & IT Infrastructure Project Manager

Alcatel Telecom · Apr 1996 – Aug 1999 · Antwerp Metropolitan Area

- IT Manager and Permanent Member of the Alcatel Belgium Information Officers Board.
- Infrastructure Project Manager for the Research department platform renewal.

CURRENT PASSIONS

- Information Technology (Cloud / On-Prem / Hybrid)
- Strategic Portfolio Management & PMO
- Using AI in Project/Program Management
- Infrastructure & ERP Digital Transformations

EDUCATION

- Project Management Institute — Master's Certificate in Project Management (PMI), 2003–2005
- The George Washington University School of Business — Masters, Commercial Project Management, 2003–2005
- Thomas More University of Applied Sciences — Master, Industrial Engineering Electronics with a major in telecommunications, 1988–1992

LICENSES & CERTIFICATIONS

- Data Landscape of GenAI for Project Managers — Project Management Institute, Issued Feb 2025
- Talking to AI: Prompt Engineering for Project Managers — PMI, Issued Feb 2025
- Generative AI Overview for Project Managers — PMI, Issued Feb 2025

- Master's Certificate in Project Management — Project Management Institute, Issued Mar 2005
- Microsoft Certified System Engineer + Internet (MCSE+I) — Microsoft, Issued Mar 2000

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Training attended and self-study — attendance, not certification:

- ITIL Fundamentals — ITIL service-management training, attended (2001)
- Practical Application of Generative AI for Project Managers (PMI)
- Generative AI Mastermind (Outskill)
- Master in Business Administration (self-study)
- Portfolio & Program Management (self-study)
- Data Center Consolidation (HPE)
- Operational IT Management (HPE)
- Solution Definition and Creation (HPE)
- Software Development in Defense Systems (FMC)
- Business Process Re-engineering (Alcatel)
- Sales & Business Negotiations (Alcatel)

Security-compliance knowledge and exposure — no certification held:

- NIS2 and ISO 27001 — through security program delivery at Cronos Security, with further exposure at Gosselin Group

INDUSTRIES OF EXPERIENCE

Logistics, Government, Pharma, Telecom, Banking, IT services & Consulting, Real-estate & building, Insurance

CUSTOMERS

Gosselin Group, CM Belgium, Umicore, PwC, Coreso SA, Johnson & Johnson, KBC, ING, Centea, Proximus, Orange (NL), Vandemoortele, FOD Finance, ERGO (Norway), Electrabel, BBTK, AIB Vincotte, Eurocontrol, Pfizer, Acerta, LCM, KONE, HP Consulting (BE, NL, UK, NO, USA), Alcatel Telecom, FMC Corporation (USA)

SPOKEN LANGUAGES

- Dutch — Native or bilingual proficiency
- English — Native or bilingual proficiency
- German — Limited working proficiency
- French — Passive understanding

SKILLS

- IT Program Management
- IT Project & Program Management
- IT Project Management
- Project Management
- IT Portfolio Management
- Project Portfolio Management
- PMO Management
- Project Management Office (PMO)
- PMO set-up
- Program Governance
- Project Governance
- Programme Delivery
- Project Planning
- Project Scheduling
- Project Coordination
- Timelines
- Risk Management
- Stakeholder Management
- Vendor Management
- Change Management
- PMI, PMP, Prince2 Methodology
- Agile Project Management
- IT Project Lifecycle
- Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC)
- Resource Planning
- Program Roadmapping
- KPIs & Metrics Management
- Key Performance Indicators
- Delivery Management
- IT Infrastructure Management
- Cloud Programs (Azure / AWS / SaaS / IaaS)
- Network & Security Infrastructure
- Network Security
- Networking
- Network Architecture
- Network Switches
- Wide Area Network (WAN)
- Virtual Private Network (VPN)
- Wireless Networking
- Microsoft Office
- Microsoft Project
- ERP Systems Implementation
- IT Transformation
- MSP / Vendor Transition
- IT Operations & Governance
- Digital Transformation
- Migration Projects
- Business-IT Alignment
- Finance Transformation Programs
- Regulated Industry Compliance
- Cross-Functional Leadership
- Multi-Cultural Team Leadership
- Team Leadership
- Executive Reporting & Steering Committees
- Planview Enterprise
- PMBOK / Standard Frameworks
- IT Budget & Cost Management
- Program KPI Dashboards
- Portfolio Reporting & Metrics
- Risk & Dependency Management
- Delivery & Change Management
- International Logistics
- Jira